🫶 Sexual Health 1: Bodies, Pregnancy & Relationships: Reading

Health · Unit 5A · Level 3 (closer to the class work) · goes with Sexual Health part 1 (Anatomy, Pregnancy, Safe Haven, Relationship Spectrum, Consent, Online Safety, Identity terms)

Name: _____

Bodies, Pregnancy and Healthy Relationships

The reproductive system makes it possible to have children. In the female reproductive system, the ovaries make eggs and hormones. Each month an egg can travel through a fallopian tube toward the uterus, a muscular organ where a fetus can grow. The cervix is the lower opening of the uterus, and it connects to the vagina. In the male reproductive system, the testicles (testes) make sperm and hormones. Sperm travel through the vas deferens, glands add fluid to make semen, and semen leaves the body through the urethra in the penis.

Puberty is the time, usually between about ages 8 and 16, when hormones cause the body to mature. Changes include growth spurts, body hair, voice changes, acne and, for people with a uterus, menstruation (periods). Everyone goes through puberty at their own pace.

Fertilization happens when a sperm joins an egg, usually in a fallopian tube. The fertilized egg implants in the lining of the uterus. A full-term pregnancy lasts about 40 weeks, divided into three trimesters: in the first, the major organs form; in the second, the fetus grows and begins to move; in the third, it gains weight and gets ready for birth. The placenta passes oxygen and nutrients to the fetus through the umbilical cord. Birth happens through the vagina or by cesarean section (C-section), a surgery. Washington's Safe Haven law allows a parent to safely and anonymously leave a newborn, within 72 hours of birth, with staff at a hospital emergency department, a staffed fire station or a federally designated rural health clinic.

Relationships fall on a spectrum. Healthy relationships have respect, trust, honesty, good communication and equality. Unhealthy relationships include jealousy, pressure, dishonesty or one person making all the decisions. Abusive relationships include control, threats, isolation or physical, emotional or sexual harm. Consent is a clear, freely given and ongoing yes, and it can be taken back at any time. Coercion, using pressure, guilt or threats, is not consent, and a person who is asleep, drunk or high cannot give consent.

Online, protect your privacy and never share passwords or your location with people you don't know. In Washington, creating, sending, asking for or keeping sexual images of anyone under 18 is illegal, even if the images are of yourself or a friend. Identity terms help us understand and respect each other: sex is assigned at birth based on the body; gender identity is a person's internal sense of their gender; sexual orientation describes who a person is attracted to. Help is available from trusted adults, the school counselor, 988, and love is respect (text LOVEIS to 22522).

Check your reading

1. Trace the path of an egg from where it is made to where a fetus grows.

2. What happens in each trimester?

3. Why is coercion not consent?